

Chapter 181 Part 1: Extra Story 4-1

After Liang Shi said at the awards ceremony that she planned to film some sweet dramas next, scripts soon came knocking at her door.

A Best Actress lowering her status to film sweet dramas was practically a blessing for audiences' eyes.

But for Liang Shi, it didn't matter much. She didn't really care about status. The endorsements she had were already substantial enough—she was endorsing a globally top luxury brand under the Shen family, as well as endorsements from Dongheng's side.

All the haute couture she wore to awards ceremonies and galas was sent directly to her home; she never needed to worry about that.

Liang Shi simply treated acting as a hobby.

Some things were indeed strange. When you treat something as a career to strive for, you feel like it's very difficult to do and the shore of your dreams is particularly hard to reach. But if you treat it as a hobby, because expectations drop dramatically, you can accomplish it without much effort.

Just like Liang Shi winning Best Actress.

She simply liked the script of "You in My Memory" and liked the role.

This time, one of the scripts that came to her was her company's self-produced drama, "Listening to the Wind Say I Love You."

Just from the name, you could tell it was a sweet drama.

It was still the standard dual female lead setup, without any melodrama or misunderstandings. Every episode found different ways to sprinkle sweetness.

There weren't many kiss scenes or bed scenes. It wasn't that kind of manufactured sugar type of sweet drama, but rather a story about how an intangible cultural heritage inheritor¹ progresses and changes amid the tide of modernization. The romance happens in the process of progressing and changing.

The feelings between the two characters in the script were all conveyed through glances and small gestures—like hooking pinkies, suddenly leaning in close to talk, foreheads touching. There were all kinds of ways to express love.

After reading the script, Liang Shi also chose to take it on.

Chaochao and Mumu had also reached kindergarten age. Liang Shi and the others didn't pick and choose, just sent them directly to a kindergarten near their home.

These two were both mischievously clever, and they caused trouble on the very first day of kindergarten.

Mumu was more lively, and her desk mate was a little boy who loved to cry.

Because it was the first day of kindergarten, the little boy couldn't bear to be away from his mom and kept crying non-stop. When the teacher asked them to get to know their new classmates, he wouldn't move, just kept crying. Mumu frowned: "Aiya, stop crying. If you keep crying, you'll become ugly."

The little boy sobbed, "Mind your own business."

Mumu comforted him: "Your mom will come when school ends. You need to listen to the teacher now."

The little boy ignored her and continued crying.

So she raised her hand to signal the teacher: "Teacher, my desk mate is ignoring me. Can I switch desk mates? I want Sheng Yan."

Sheng Yan, whose full name was called, was in the middle of introducing herself to her desk mate, a little girl. They were almost done. The little girl had two little pigtails, was milky white, and spoke in a small voice, but Sheng Yan was encouraging her to speak louder. The two were getting along fairly smoothly.

When Mumu called out like this, the whole class turned their eyes toward them.

The teacher immediately ran over, "Little friend Shen Xuan, what's wrong?"

"He keeps crying and crying." Shen Xuan covered one ear, "My ear hurts from the noise. I want to sit with Sheng Yan."

When they had dropped them off at kindergarten, Xu Qingzhu had specifically communicated with the teacher, hoping the two children could be in the same class but not sit together as desk mates.

Being in kindergarten could also help develop both their social skills.

Mumu was doing okay, but for Chaochao, this was probably the best opportunity to help her make friends—preferably with some more lively children. Otherwise, Chaochao's personality was too reserved. As for Mumu, she needed to be paired with someone who could help her calm down.

The teacher had arranged it this way, but now Mumu was openly complaining about her desk mate, putting the teacher in a difficult position.

Before the teacher could resolve it, Sheng Yan said: "Teacher, I don't want to sit with classmate Shen Xuan."

Mumu: "?"

The teacher immediately tried to soothe Shen Xuan, reasoning with her, hoping she could encourage her desk mate.

The result was Shen Xuan saying to the still crying little boy: "Can't you be a bit stronger? This is really ugly, you know."

Hearing this, the little boy cried even harder.

His reason was that Shen Xuan was being mean to him, and he also wanted to switch desk mates.

Shen Xuan got anxious, widened her eyes and slapped the desk: "When was I mean to you?"

The little boy covered his face: "Right... now..."

He was already crying so hard he could barely breathe.

And so, Shen Xuan was quietly spoken to by the teacher—it couldn't even be called a reprimand.

But Shen Xuan was feeling gloomy. When the little boy was about to go out, she stuck out her foot and tripped him. The little boy fell to the ground and cried that he wanted to go home.

Shen Xuan: "....."

Because the other child had bruised his forehead, the teacher kept both sets of parents after school, explained the situation, and mediated.

Shen Xuan also knew she had done wrong. She apologized to him with her head drooping.

The other parent was also reasonable and didn't make a big fuss. They just said their child was somewhat introverted and had delicate skin that bruised easily with just a little pinch, so they hoped the new desk mate could be more careful and not bully him.

That day, both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu came to pick them up. After apologizing to the other parent, they took Shen Xuan and Sheng Yan home.

The atmosphere on the way home was gloomy. Shen Xuan sat in the back of the car curled up into a ball, as if she had been bullied.

As soon as they entered the house, Xu Qingzhu asked Liang Shi: "You or me?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi glanced at Shen Xuan, who was wearing a pink backpack with her head hanging down. She already couldn't bear it, but she knew this matter definitely required serious discipline. She was also afraid that once she saw Shen Xuan's tears, she wouldn't be able to hold firm.

Before she could answer, Xu Qingzhu had already seen through her soft-heartedness and sighed: "I'll do it."

Then she crossed her arms and looked at Shen Xuan, "Shen Xuan, come with me."

She deliberately called her by her full name very seriously.

Mumu actually shuddered in fright. When she looked up at Xu Qingzhu, she was extremely guilty, the corners of her eyes already red, like a little white rabbit.

The little one had never experienced something like this before. After that child fell, when he cried, she had also cried along.

Because she knew she had done something wrong.

On the way to the study following Xu Qingzhu, she had already started to sob, terrified.

After Xu Qingzhu brought her into the study and closed the door, she stood there and shuddered.

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1. "非遗传承人" (fēi yí chuán chéng rén) refers to an inheritor of intangible cultural heritage. In China, this is an officially recognized designation for individuals who carry on traditional crafts, arts, or cultural practices that have been designated as protected cultural heritage by the government. ↵